

# Seven applications, four strategies, one thing to do this month.

From 197 verified programmes and 139 funding schemes across Spain, the Netherlands and Berlin. Ranked on funding odds (40%), admission fit for your 300-ECTS engineering diploma (25%), path priority (15%), city (10%) and cost (10%), with a 15% penalty on German-taught programmes.

## The data is four strategies, not 197 options

| STRATEGY         | WHAT YOU GET                                                    | WHAT IT COSTS YOU                                      |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Berlin technical | Best subject fit in Europe, tuition-free                        | German C1 — 12–18 months you have not started          |
| Andalusia cheap  | A real master's for ~€821 total, engineering-friendly admission | Zero music content region-wide, and Spanish B2         |
| Funded mobility  | Money, English, prestige                                        | Deadlines in Dec–Jan, subject fit that wanders         |
| Barcelona        | Exactly the degree you want                                     | Unverified — its own site blocked every attempt, twice |

### The uncomfortable finding

The single best subject match in this sweep — **UPF Barcelona's Sound and Music Computing**, home of the Music Technology Group — could not be verified. Its tuition, its 2027 deadline and its access list are all unread: `upf.edu` returned 403 to every method across two verification waves, five hosts, and a direct attempt, down to `robots.txt`. Twenty minutes in a normal browser settles it, and it could displace entry 02 below.

Decision Brief · Master's September 2027

01 · BERLIN A C G H R

## Audiokommunikation und -technologie, M.Sc.

TU Berlin — Fachgebiet Audiokommunikation

- The best credential fit found anywhere: the admission text names engineering degrees first and asks for exactly the maths and programming you already hold.
- The only **yes\_explicit** on its path, from a group that leads Europe on spatial audio. Its deadline is late enough to sit outside the December scramble.

|              |                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cost         | €0 tuition · ~€750/yr semester fee, transport ticket included                                                                        |
| Funding      | No programme scholarship. It does not need one — this is the cheapest real degree in the sweep.                                      |
| Deadline     | 15 June (window 1 Apr–15 Jun) · 2026 cycle, 2027 TBC                                                                                 |
| Biggest risk | German C1. That is 12–18 months from a standing start, and it is the entire decision — nothing else about this programme blocks you. |

## Máster Universitario en Ingeniería Acústica

Universidad de Málaga — E.T.S. Ingeniería de Telecomunicación

- A real *título oficial* in acoustics for the price of a phone, inside the telecommunications school with an anechoic Audio & Electroacoustics Lab.
- Its access list names *Ingeniería Informática* explicitly, and a student-stay authorisation counts as residence — the opposite of Madrid, where the same paperwork multiplies the fee sixfold.

Cost €820.80 total · 60 ECTS · 12 months

Funding Needs no scholarship to be affordable. Andalusia levies no nationality surcharge — confirmed against Decreto 98/2023.

Deadline **29 January · DUA Fase 1, reserved for foreign-qualification applicants**

**Biggest risk** Spanish B2, and acoustics is engineering rather than music-making. Andalusia has no music provision at all — *SONIDO* returns zero results region-wide.

## Human-Computer Interaction & Design with Extended Reality

EIT Digital Master School — Twente and Madrid entry points

- Wave 1 recorded EIT funding as closed to non-EU applicants. That was half wrong and the error would have discarded a fully funded route.
- Only the Scholarship of Excellence — the one adding a living allowance — is EU-only, and the admission text handles longer technical degrees case-by-case.

Cost €18,000/yr list price — but the full tuition waiver is open to all nationalities

Funding Strongest verified funding odds in English. Waivers state “Available to: All students”; a BME waiver stacks; an EIF plan defers all fees to six months after graduation.

Deadline **2027 dates unpublished · the 2026 equivalent closed in early January**

**Biggest risk** You must apply in **Period 1**. In Period 2, Twente and UNITN admit non-EU entrants only if they already hold a Dutch permit — applying from Tunisia then is an auto-reject.

## Act on this before any application

### ESMT Berlin — Panzer Scholarship: €35,000 against €36,000 of tuition

Plus ten months of Berlin housing. Three conditions: **under 30, citizen and resident of an African country, has founded a business or social enterprise.**

You satisfy two today. The third is the only eligibility requirement in all 197 rows you can *manufacture* — register a small venture around your production work now, so it is met by the 2027 application. Nothing else here turns a weekend into €35,000.

## Best per path

| PATH | PROGRAMME                                          | VERDICT                                                                                                              |
|------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A    | TU Berlin — Audiokommunikation<br>€0               | See 01. German C1 is the only gate.                                                                                  |
| C    | UGR — Ciencia de Datos, Granada<br>€820.80         | Path-C gate genuinely passed: UGR's <b>SigMAT</b> group works on speech recognition and voice synthesis. Spanish B2. |
| N    | TU Berlin — IMES, M.Sc.<br>€0                      | <b>English-taught</b> , free, <b>yes_explicit</b> — the only Berlin row that is all three. 15 May.                   |
| H    | TU Berlin + Sonology double degree<br>€0 → €11,488 | Berlin then The Hague. <b>15 Feb.</b> Both languages bind: IELTS 6.0 and TestDaF TDN 4.                              |
| G    | Netherlands Film Academy<br>€8,250/yr              | Cheapest non-EU Dutch master, and the only hard timed 2027 date: <b>12 Jan 2027, 12:00 CET.</b>                      |
| R    | — none exists —                                    | NL and Spain have none. BHT Berlin's is real but <b>summer-intake only</b> . Treat R as a post-master's add-on.      |
| J    | Macromedia Berlin — Music Management<br>€13,680    | English, state-recognised, no subject bar. 300 ECTS unlocks the 3-semester route: –6 months, –€6,840.                |
| L    | ESMT Berlin<br>€36,000 → ~€1,000 net               | See the panel opposite.                                                                                              |
| AC   | UMA — Dirección y Gestión de Marketing<br>€820.80  | <b>yes_explicit</b> at Andalusian prices; most Dutch and Berlin marketing masters reject engineers.                  |
| AD   | UGR — Nuevos Medios Interactivos<br>€820.80        | The only cheap AD row not demanding 30 ECTS of prior media studies.                                                  |

File these seven

Funding-first, A/C/N anchored, capped at two self-funded business options. **Applications 3, 4 and 5 are Andalusian publics and share one DUA form with six ranked choices** — three of the seven cost you a single submission.

| # | PROGRAMME                          | WHY IT IS ON THE LIST                                                  |
|---|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | TU Berlin — IMES                   | Free, English, <b>yes_explicit</b> . The no-regret anchor.             |
| 2 | TU Berlin — Audiokommunikation     | The subject prize. Only if German C1 is underway by spring 2027.       |
| 3 | UMA — Ingeniería Acústica          | €821 for a real acoustics degree. Your cheapest outcome.               |
| 4 | UGR — Ciencia de Datos (SigMAT)    | Same price, real audio research group.                                 |
| 5 | UJA Linares — Telecom Engineering  | €757, <b>English-taught, B1 only</b> . Removes both language barriers. |
| 6 | EIT Digital HCID/XR — Period 1     | Best odds of a full tuition waiver in English.                         |
| 7 | ESMT Berlin <div>self-funded</div> | Only if the venture exists by then.                                    |

Held in reserve, not filed blind

**UPF Barcelona** — verify first; it may displace entry 02. **Berklee Valencia** (self-funded slot 2) — a real Spanish *título oficial* plus US accreditation, portfolio gate is a one-minute business-idea video rather than an audition, but ~USD 50,430 with scholarships capped at 90%. **Erasmus Mundus** — an unconfirmed report says 37 new projects were selected in July 2026 for September 2027 starts; re-sweep the EACEA catalogue in October.

Risk — everything unverified that could change this picture

These rows appear here and **nowhere else**. None is in the tracker, the calendar or the dossiers: a date that might be wrong is worse than a blank one. Of 197 programmes, 105 are VERIFIED and 74 partially; the 18 below are not.

| ID     | INSTITUTION                                  | STATUS    | WHY IT IS UNRESOLVED                                                           |
|--------|----------------------------------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A-014  | Universitat Pompeu Fabra (UPF) - Department  | UNVERIFIE | BLOCKED SOURCE: upf.edu returned HTTP 403 (Cloudflare "Just a moment..." JS bo |
| A-016  | Universitat Pompeu Fabra (UPF) - Music Techn | UNVERIFIE | upf.edu returned Cloudflare 403 to every request this session (WebFetch and cu |
| A-020  | Universidad Loyola Andalucía                 | UNVERIFIE | Fees NOT verified and NOT covered by the Andalusian decree - do not assume the |
| A-029  | ArtEZ University of the Arts - Academy of Po | DEAD LINK | DISCONTINUED - 'From the 2025-2026 academic year onwards, no new students will |
| A-036  | SRH Berlin University of Applied Sciences -  | UNVERIFIE | hdpk.de returned HTTP 503 to every attempt (WebFetch and curl) and the SRH mas |
| AC-041 | Maastricht University, School of Business an | UNVERIFIE | Nothing could be read off the official pages beyond the programme's existence  |
| AC-044 | Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus Univ | CONFLICT  | MOST EXPENSIVE DUTCH OPTION at 25800 EUR/yr. Application CAP of 520 means the  |
| AD-064 | Hochschule Macromedia (Macromedia University | CONFLICT  | NOTHING ON THIS ROW IS CONFIRMED. Site actively blocked automated access (403) |
| AD-065 | Humboldt-Universitaet zu Berlin              | UNVERIFIE | Unverified. Almost certainly German-taught and theory-led (Medienwissenschaft  |

Also material: **RSM Rotterdam** states both €25,800 and “approximately €15,200 for non-EEA students” for 2027-28 *on the same page*. **Spain** is the least resolved region — of 46 schemes only MAEC-AECID is confirmed open at full+stipend, 20 unclear. And **accepts\_engineering\_bachelor changed on ~40% of rows in verification**: distrust any eligibility claim not carried through Wave 3. Full list: [GAPS . md](#).